

Environmental variables for the 2027 SEAK Pink Salmon Preseason Forecast

Sara Miller

September 2026

Objective

The overall objective is to test a variety of temperature variables, using satellite sea surface temperature (SST) data or Southeast Alaska Coastal Monitoring project (SECM) data, within the forecasting model framework to forecast the 2027 pink salmon harvest in Southeast Alaska (SEAK). This write-up is a summary of available SST variables based on satellite data (i.e., average of May (May), the average over the months of May through July (MJJ), the average over the months of April through June (AMJ), or the average over the months of April through July (AMJJ) from 1997 through 2026) over four regions of SEAK; Icy Strait, Icy and Chatham Straits, northern southeast Alaska (NSEAK), and SEAK. This write-up also includes a summary of SECM survey data from various months (i.e., the average over the months of May, June, and July (MJJ)) at 20 m depths of the SECM transects (i.e., Icy Strait and Upper Chatham transects stations ISA, ISB, ISC, ISD, UCA, UCB, UCC, UCD) from 1997 through 2026.

Methods

Satellite-derived SST data

Satellite-derived sea surface temperature (SST) data from April 1997 through July 2026 were pulled from the 'SST and SST Anomaly, NOAA Global Coral Bleaching Monitoring, 5km, V.3.1, Monthly, 1985-Present' time series (https://coastwatch.pfeg.noaa.gov/erddap/griddap/NOAA_DHW_monthly.html; full citation in references). This satellite-derived SST data set was then matched to pre-determined coordinates from four spatial regions that corresponded with sixteen variables of interest (four regions; four temporal variables per region).

Satellite-derived SST variables

Icy_Strait_SST_May: The Icy Strait region encompasses waters of Icy Strait from the east end of Lemesurier Island to a line from Point Couverden south to Point Augusta. This variable is the average SST in May (Table 1; Figure 1; Figure 5a).

Icy_Strait_SST_MJJ: The Icy Strait region encompasses waters of Icy Strait from the east end of Lemesurier Island to a line from Point Couverden south to Point Augusta. This variable is the average SST in May through July (Table 1; Figure 1; Figure 5b).

Icy_Strait_SST_AMJ: The Icy Strait region encompasses waters of Icy Strait from the east end of Lemesurier Island to a line from Point Couverden south to Point Augusta. This variable is the average SST in April through June (Table 1; Figure 1; Figure 5c).

Icy_Strait_SST_AMJJ: The Icy Strait region encompasses waters of Icy Strait from the east end of Lemesurier Island to a line from Point Couverden south to Point Augusta. This variable is the average SST in April through July (Table 1; Figure 1; Figure 5d).

Chatham_SST_May: The Chatham and Icy Straits region encompasses waters of Chatham and Icy Straits east of Lemesurier Island to Point Couverden, and south to the approximate latitude of 56.025 degrees north (roughly Cape Decision off Kuiu Island) (Figure 2 and Figure 5a; Table 2). This variable is the average SST in May.

Chatham_SST_MJJ: The Chatham and Icy Straits region encompasses waters of Chatham and Icy Straits east of Lemesurier Island to Point Couverden, south to the approximate latitude of 56.025 degrees north (roughly Cape Decision off Kuiu Island) (Figure 2 and Figure 5b; Table 2). This variable is the average SST in May through July.

Chatham_SST_AMJ: The Chatham and Icy Straits region encompasses waters of Chatham and Icy Straits east of Lemesurier Island to Point Couverden, south to the approximate latitude of 56.025 degrees north (roughly Cape Decision off Kuiu Island) (Figure 2 and Figure 5c; Table 2). This variable is the average SST in April through June.

Chatham_SST_AMJJ: The Chatham and Icy Straits region encompasses waters of Chatham and Icy Straits east of Lemesurier Island to Point Couverden, south to the approximate latitude of 56.025 degrees north (roughly Cape Decision off Kuiu Island) (Figure 2 and Figure 5d; Table 2). This variable is the average SST in April through July.

NSEAK_SST_May: The NSEAK region encompasses northern Southeast Alaska from 59.475 to 56.075 degrees north latitude (approximately Districts 9 through 15, and District 13 inside area only; northern Southeast Inside subregion for Southeast Alaska (NSEI); Figure 3 and Figure 5a; Table 3). This variable is the average SST in May.

NSEAK_SST_MJJ: The NSEAK region encompasses northern Southeast Alaska from 59.475 to 56.075 degrees north latitude (approximately Districts 9 through 15, and District 13 inside area only; northern Southeast Inside subregion for Southeast Alaska (NSEI); Figure 3 and Figure 5b; Table 3). This variable is the average SST in May through July.

NSEAK_SST_AMJ: The NSEAK region encompasses northern Southeast Alaska from 59.475 to 56.075 degrees north latitude (approximately Districts 9 through 15, and District 13 inside area only; northern Southeast Inside subregion for Southeast Alaska (NSEI); Figure 3 and Figure 5c; Table 3). This variable is the average SST in April through June.

NSEAK_SST_AMJJ: The NSEAK region encompasses northern Southeast Alaska from 59.475 to 56.075 degrees north latitude (approximately Districts 9 through 15, and District 13 inside area only; northern Southeast Inside subregion for Southeast Alaska (NSEI); Figure 3 and Figure 5d; Table 3). This variable is the average SST in April through July.

SEAK_SST_May: The SEAK region encompasses Southeast Alaska from 59.475 to 54.725 degrees north latitude (Figure 4 and Figure 5a; Table 4). This variable is the average SST in May.

SEAK_SST_MJJ: The SEAK region encompasses northern Southeast Alaska from 59.475 to 54.725 degrees north latitude (Figure 4 and Figure 5b; Table 4). This variable is the average SST in May through July.

SEAK_SST_AMJ: The SEAK region encompasses Southeast Alaska from 59.475 to 54.725 degrees north latitude (Figure 4 and Figure 5c; Table 4). This variable is the average SST in April through June.

SEAK_SST_AMJJ: The SEAK region encompasses Southeast Alaska from 59.475 to 54.725 degrees north latitude (Figure 4 and Figure 5d; Table 4). This variable is the average SST in April through July.

SECM survey temperature data

SECM survey temperature data were summarized by year (1997 to 2026), month (average over the months of June and July) at 20m depths for the Icy Strait and Upper Chatham transects combined.

SECM survey temperature variables

ISTI20__JJ: Average temperature in the upper 20m during June through July at 8 stations in Icy Strait (Icy Strait and Upper Chatham transects; Figure 1; Figure 6; Table 5).

Results

Satellite-derived SST data

Satellite sea surface temperature data were summarized by region and year (i.e., average of May (May), the average over the months of May, June, and July (MJJ), the average over the months of April through June (AMJ), or the average over the months of April through July (AMJJ)) from 1997 to 2026 (Tables 1 through 4).

Table 1: Satellite sea temperature data from the Icy Strait region from 1997 to 2026 for the month of May (May), May through July (MJJ), April through June (AMJ), and April through July (AMJJ). There are 70 satellite stations (latitude/longitude combinations) in the Icy Strait region.

year	Icy_Strait_SST_MJJ	Icy_Strait_SST_May	Icy_Strait_SST_AMJJ	Icy_Strait_SST_AMJ
1997	10.30	7.01	8.83	7.30
1998	9.97	7.34	8.85	7.56
1999	9.08	6.17	8.02	6.78
2000	9.94	7.02	8.67	7.35
2001	9.57	6.48	8.40	7.08
2002	9.34	6.26	8.02	6.60
2003	10.08	7.29	8.88	7.53
2004	10.68	7.53	9.25	7.69
2005	11.16	8.40	9.64	8.26
2006	10.19	6.84	8.86	7.49
2007	9.49	6.55	8.16	6.87
2008	8.85	6.43	7.72	6.68
2009	9.94	7.19	8.47	7.22
2010	9.87	7.71	8.68	7.81
2011	9.84	6.81	8.47	7.18
2012	9.23	6.92	8.10	7.07
2013	9.88	6.37	8.45	6.97
2014	10.23	7.90	8.81	7.62
2015	10.73	8.34	9.43	8.29
2016	11.65	8.81	10.37	9.14
2017	9.82	7.22	8.66	7.51
2018	9.99	6.92	8.74	7.43
2019	10.74	7.79	9.51	8.10
2020	10.40	7.83	9.05	7.86
2021	10.26	6.91	8.91	7.47
2022	10.34	7.13	8.88	7.40
2023	9.72	7.13	8.43	7.10
2024	9.86	7.41	8.80	7.65
2025	9.41	7.06	8.34	7.19
2026	9.13	6.41	7.92	6.77

Table 2: Satellite sea temperature data from the Chatham and Icy Straits region from 1997 to 2026 for the month of May (May), May through July (MJJ), April through June (AMJ), and April through July (AMJJ). There are 313 satellite stations (latitude/longitude combinations) in the Chatham and Icy Straits region.

year	Chatham_SST_MJJ	Chatham_SST_May	Chatham_SST_AMJJ	Chatham_SST_AMJ
1997	10.08	7.48	8.83	7.59
1998	9.85	7.83	8.91	7.88
1999	8.90	6.84	8.05	7.12
2000	9.70	7.34	8.62	7.52
2001	9.15	6.74	8.18	7.12
2002	8.97	6.39	7.85	6.64
2003	9.92	7.71	8.90	7.85
2004	10.43	7.94	9.22	7.96
2005	10.67	8.51	9.48	8.44
2006	9.78	7.16	8.68	7.58
2007	9.52	7.04	8.41	7.27
2008	8.65	6.77	7.69	6.83
2009	9.75	7.30	8.46	7.35
2010	9.65	7.97	8.66	7.93
2011	9.59	7.31	8.49	7.55
2012	9.17	7.07	8.18	7.22
2013	9.66	6.74	8.44	7.21
2014	9.98	8.17	8.76	7.77
2015	10.62	8.87	9.55	8.73
2016	11.04	8.92	10.03	9.07
2017	9.65	7.65	8.70	7.76
2018	9.87	7.40	8.75	7.61
2019	10.47	8.24	9.46	8.35
2020	9.99	8.09	8.84	7.86
2021	10.06	7.25	8.90	7.63
2022	10.17	7.52	8.92	7.64
2023	9.80	7.53	8.61	7.40
2024	9.71	7.76	8.82	7.92
2025	9.49	7.47	8.56	7.57
2026	9.20	6.92	8.21	7.24

Table 3: Satellite sea temperature from the northern Southeast Alaska (NSEAK) region from 1997 to 2026 for the month of May (May), May through July (MJJ), April through June (AMJ), and April through July (AMJJ). There are 1,344 satellite stations (latitude/longitude combinations) in the NSEAK region.

year	NSEAK_SST_MJJ	NSEAK_SST_May	NSEAK_SST_AMJJ	NSEAK_SST_AMJ
1997	10.02	7.35	8.71	7.40
1998	9.89	7.65	8.85	7.71
1999	8.93	6.70	7.98	6.95
2000	9.70	7.23	8.57	7.39
2001	9.22	6.66	8.17	7.01
2002	9.05	6.39	7.88	6.61
2003	9.86	7.57	8.76	7.60
2004	10.38	7.89	9.09	7.79
2005	10.63	8.42	9.35	8.26
2006	9.72	6.98	8.55	7.36
2007	9.44	6.90	8.24	7.03
2008	8.65	6.64	7.63	6.74
2009	9.77	7.32	8.40	7.24
2010	9.62	7.76	8.54	7.72
2011	9.67	7.25	8.44	7.44
2012	9.14	6.95	8.09	7.10
2013	9.67	6.59	8.36	7.04
2014	10.03	8.15	8.70	7.64
2015	10.81	8.92	9.56	8.65
2016	11.18	8.92	10.05	9.00
2017	9.82	7.75	8.77	7.78
2018	10.11	7.53	8.86	7.63
2019	10.87	8.42	9.65	8.44
2020	10.23	8.26	8.98	7.94
2021	10.23	7.29	8.96	7.65
2022	10.52	7.62	9.11	7.74
2023	9.98	7.53	8.69	7.41
2024	9.95	7.81	8.93	7.92
2025	9.57	7.39	8.54	7.46
2026	9.38	6.98	8.22	7.19

Table 4: Satellite sea temperature from the Southeast Alaska (SEAK) region from 1997 to 2026 for the month of May (May), May through July (MJJ), April through June (AMJ), and April through July (AMJJ). There are 2,663 satellite stations (latitude/longitude combinations) in the SEAK region.

year	SEAK_SST_MJJ	SEAK_SST_May	SEAK_SST_AMJJ	SEAK_SST_AMJ
1997	10.47	8.00	9.20	7.99
1998	10.36	8.37	9.38	8.37
1999	9.30	7.23	8.40	7.43
2000	10.02	7.71	8.95	7.86
2001	9.51	7.10	8.52	7.45
2002	9.44	6.92	8.33	7.14
2003	10.32	8.17	9.25	8.16
2004	10.98	8.58	9.74	8.51
2005	11.06	8.92	9.83	8.82
2006	10.19	7.63	9.07	7.96
2007	9.99	7.51	8.82	7.64
2008	9.18	7.22	8.17	7.28
2009	10.20	7.76	8.85	7.73
2010	10.09	8.28	9.05	8.23
2011	10.05	7.74	8.88	7.92
2012	9.68	7.47	8.63	7.61
2013	10.39	7.51	9.10	7.85
2014	10.57	8.62	9.26	8.17
2015	11.43	9.64	10.21	9.32
2016	11.67	9.61	10.59	9.59
2017	10.31	8.25	9.28	8.29
2018	10.79	8.28	9.54	8.30
2019	11.46	9.01	10.25	9.05
2020	10.70	8.90	9.52	8.53
2021	10.82	7.97	9.58	8.31
2022	11.04	8.22	9.68	8.38
2023	10.68	8.21	9.35	8.04
2024	10.49	8.46	9.51	8.52
2025	10.25	8.02	9.23	8.16
2026	10.24	7.93	9.09	8.11

SECM survey temperature data

SECM survey temperature data were summarized by year (1997 to 2026), month (average over the months of June and July) at 20m depths; Table 5).

Table 5: The SECM survey temperature data were summarized by year (1997 to 2026), month (the months of June and July; JJ) at 20m depths for the Icy Strait and Upper Chatham transects (stations ISA, ISB, ISC, ISD, UCA, UCB, UCC, UCD).

Year	ISTI20_JJ
1997	10.295
1998	10.405
1999	9.645
2000	9.925
2001	10.150
2002	9.105
2003	10.250
2004	10.310
2005	11.150
2006	9.745
2007	9.880
2008	8.755
2009	10.075
2010	9.785
2011	9.725
2012	9.400
2013	9.975
2014	9.850
2015	10.595
2016	10.960
2017	8.995
2018	9.430
2019	10.905
2020	9.600
2021	9.715
2022	10.000
2023	9.855
2024	10.230
2025	9.505
2026	9.420

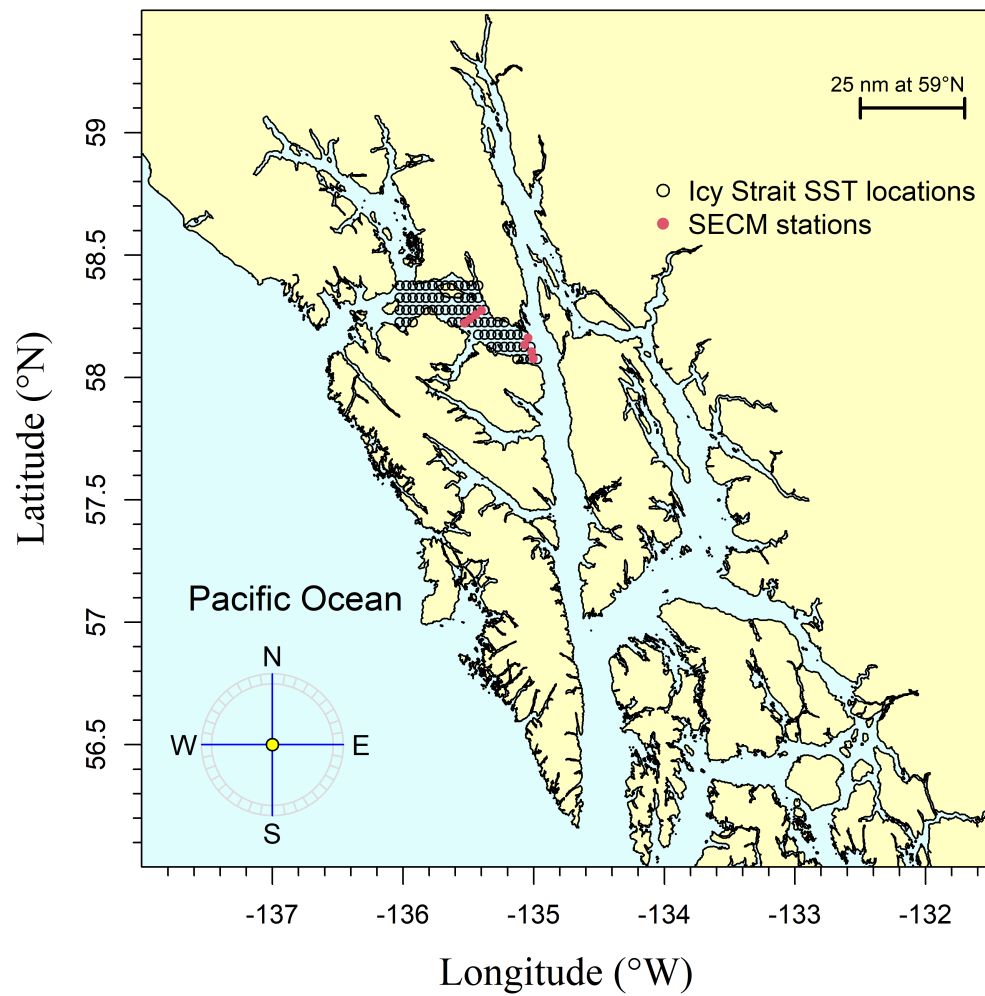


Figure 1: The Icy Strait region encompasses waters of Icy Strait from the east end of Lemesurier Island to a line from Point Couverden south to Point Augusta. The Southeast Coastal Monitoring (SECM) project transects (Upper Chatham Strait and Icy Strait) are shown as red points for comparison to the satellite stations (i.e., data points; black circles).

Acknowledgements

Jordan Watson (NOAA) helped with the code to process the satellite data into a usable format. The data was accessed through NOAA’s Coral Reef Watch (https://coastwatch.pfeg.noaa.gov/erddap/griddap/NOAA_DHW_monthly.html and https://coastwatch.pfeg.noaa.gov/erddap/griddap/NOAA_DHW.html). Emily Fergusson summarized the SECM survey data by year, month, and depth. All code and associated data are located here: https://github.com/commfish/southeast_pink_salmon_preseason in the 2026_forecast folder.

References

- Huang, B., P. W. Thorne, V. F. Banzon,, T. Boyer, G. Chepurin, J. H. Lawrimore, M. J. Menne, T. M. Smith, R. S. Vose, and H. M. Zhang. 2017. Extended reconstructed sea surface temperature, version 5 (ERSSTv5): upgrades, validations, and intercomparisons. *Journal of Climate* 30:8179–8205.
- NOAA Coral Reef Watch (NOAA_DHW_monthly dataset). 2022, updated daily. NOAA Coral Reef Watch Version 3.1 Monthly 5km SST and SST Anomaly, NOAA Global Coral Bleaching Monitoring Time Series Data, May 1997-June 2021. College Park, Maryland, USA: NOAA/NESDIS/STAR Coral Reef Watch program. Data set accessed 2024-10-16 at https://coastwatch.pfeg.noaa.gov/erddap/griddap/NOAA_DHW_monthly.html.
- NOAA Coral Reef Watch (NOAA_DHW dataset). 2022, updated daily. NOAA Coral Reef Watch Daily Near-real-Time Global 5km SST and SST Anomaly, NOAA Global Coral Bleaching Monitoring Time Series Data, July 2021 to July 2022. College Park, Maryland, USA: NOAA/NESDIS/STAR Coral Reef Watch program. Data set accessed 2024-10-16 at https://coastwatch.pfeg.noaa.gov/erddap/griddap/NOAA_DHW.html.
- Piston, A. W., J. Murphy, J. Moss, W. Strasburger, S. C. Heintz, E. Fergusson, S. Miller, A. Gray, and C. Waters. 2021. Operational Plan: Southeast coastal monitoring, 2021. ADF&G, Regional Operational Plan No. ROP.CF.1J.2021.02, Douglas.

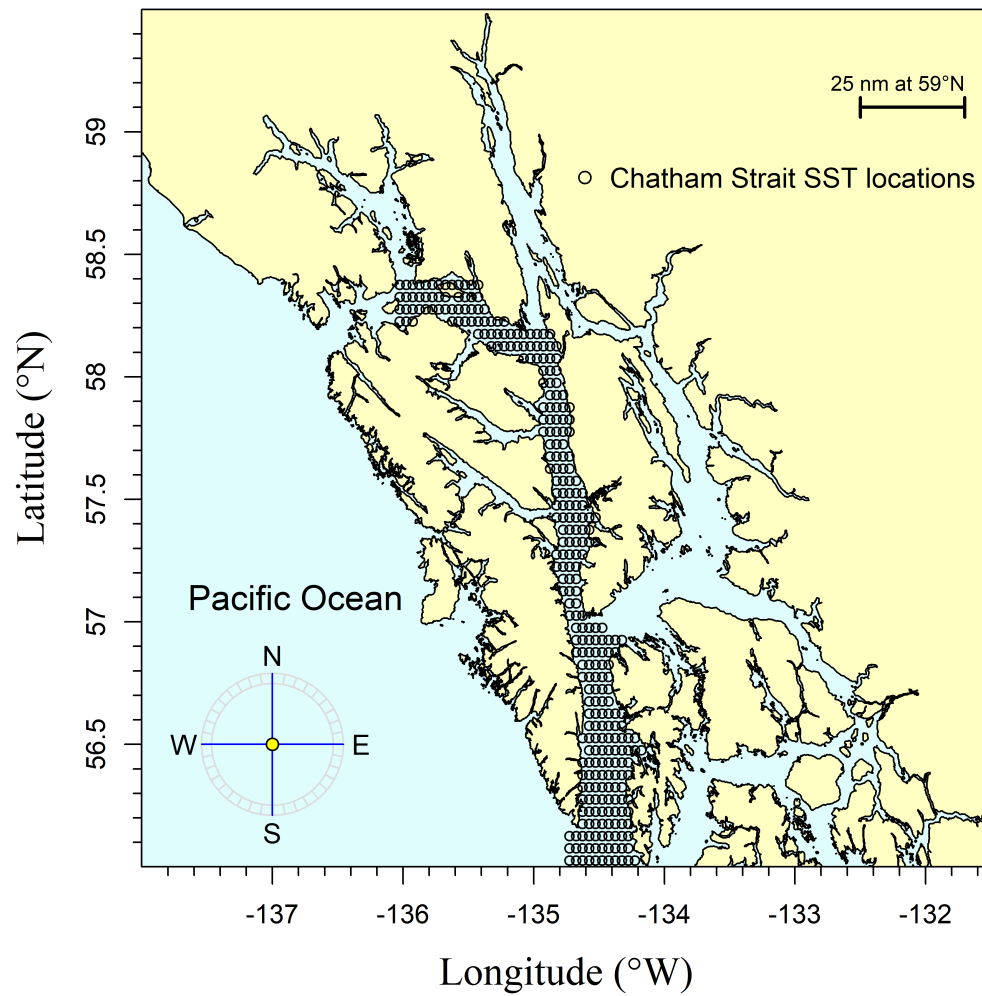


Figure 2: The Chatham and Icy Straits region encompasses waters of Chatham and Icy Straits east of Lemesurier Island to Point Couverden, south to the approximate latitude of 56.025 degrees north (roughly Cape Decision off Kuiu Island). The black circles are the satellite stations (i.e., data points).

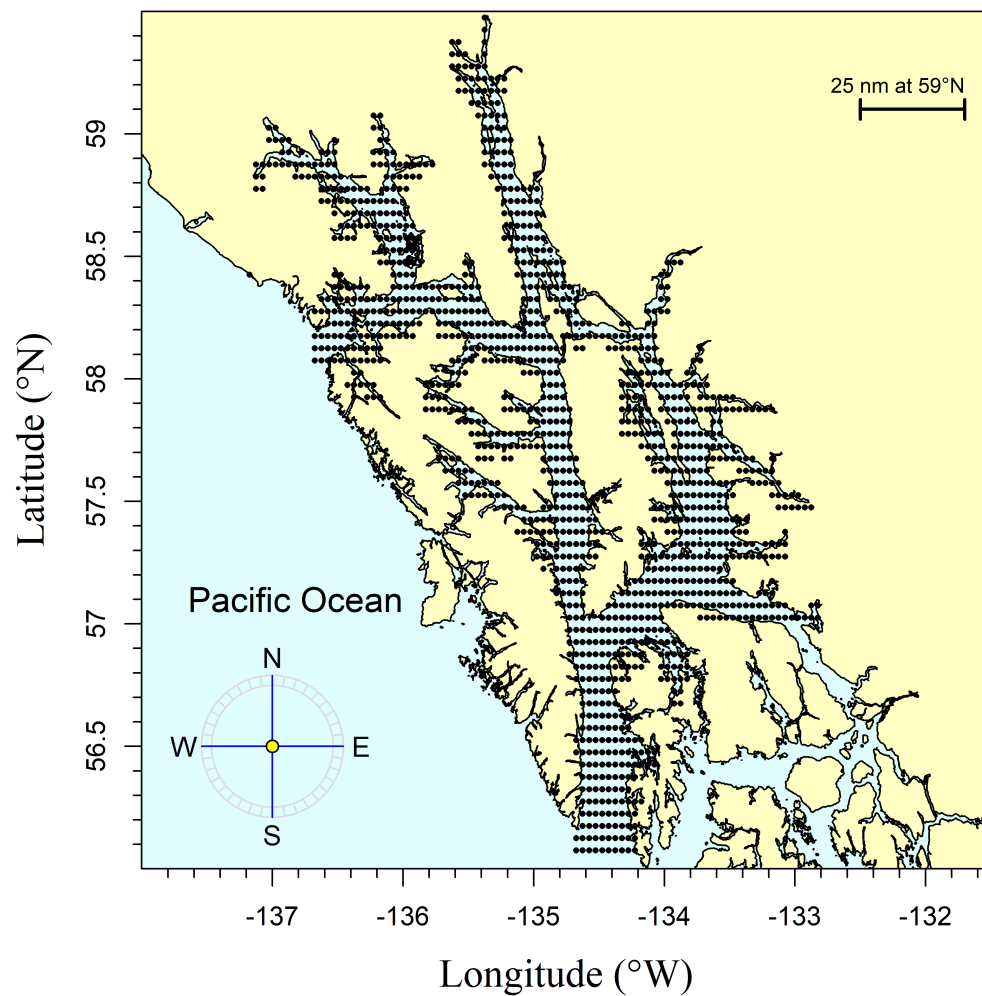


Figure 3: The northern Southeast Alaska (NSEAK) region encompasses northern Southeast Alaska from 59.475 to 56.075 degrees north latitude and from -137.175 to -132.825 degrees west longitude. The black circles are the satellite stations (i.e., data points).

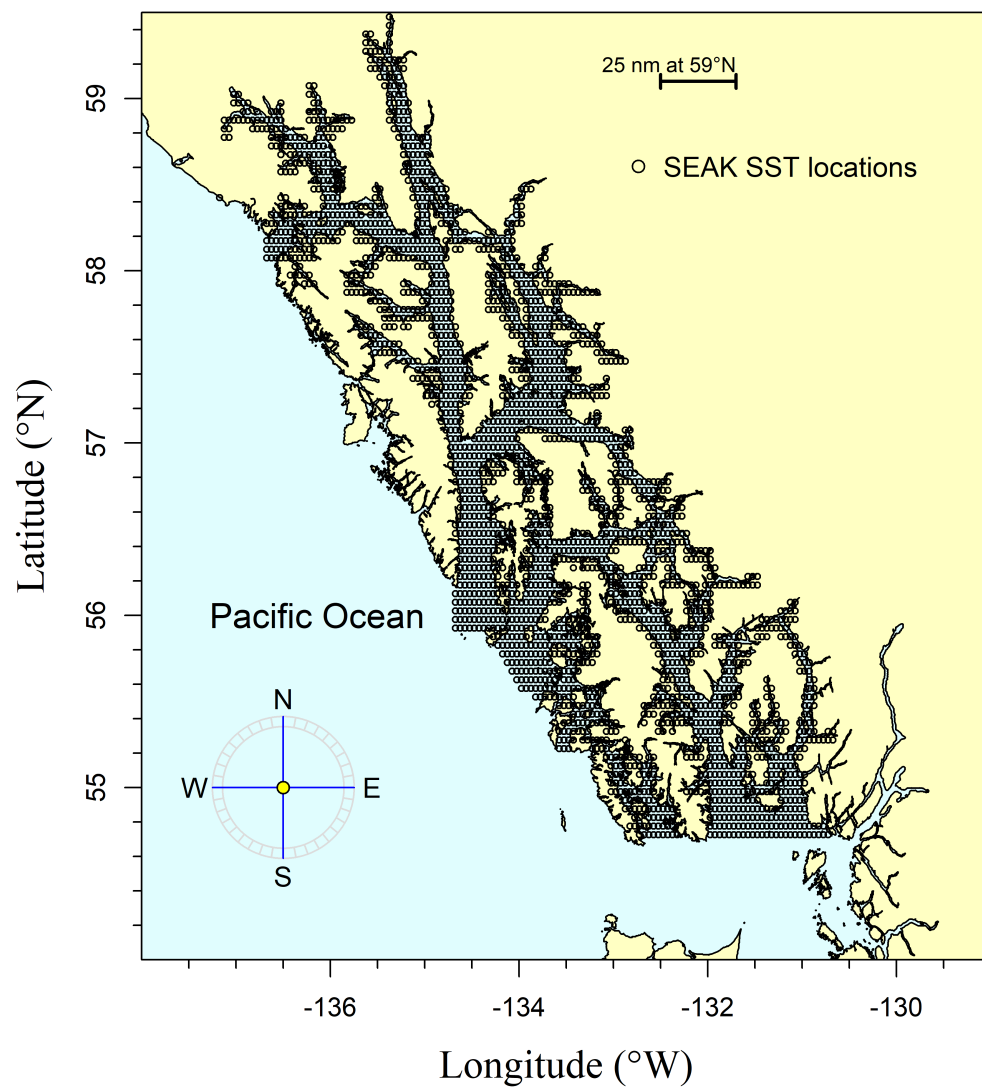


Figure 4: The Southeast Alaska (SEAK) region encompasses Southeast Alaska from 59.475 to 54.725 degrees north latitude and from -137.175 to -130.675 degrees west longitude. The black circles are the satellite stations (i.e., data points).

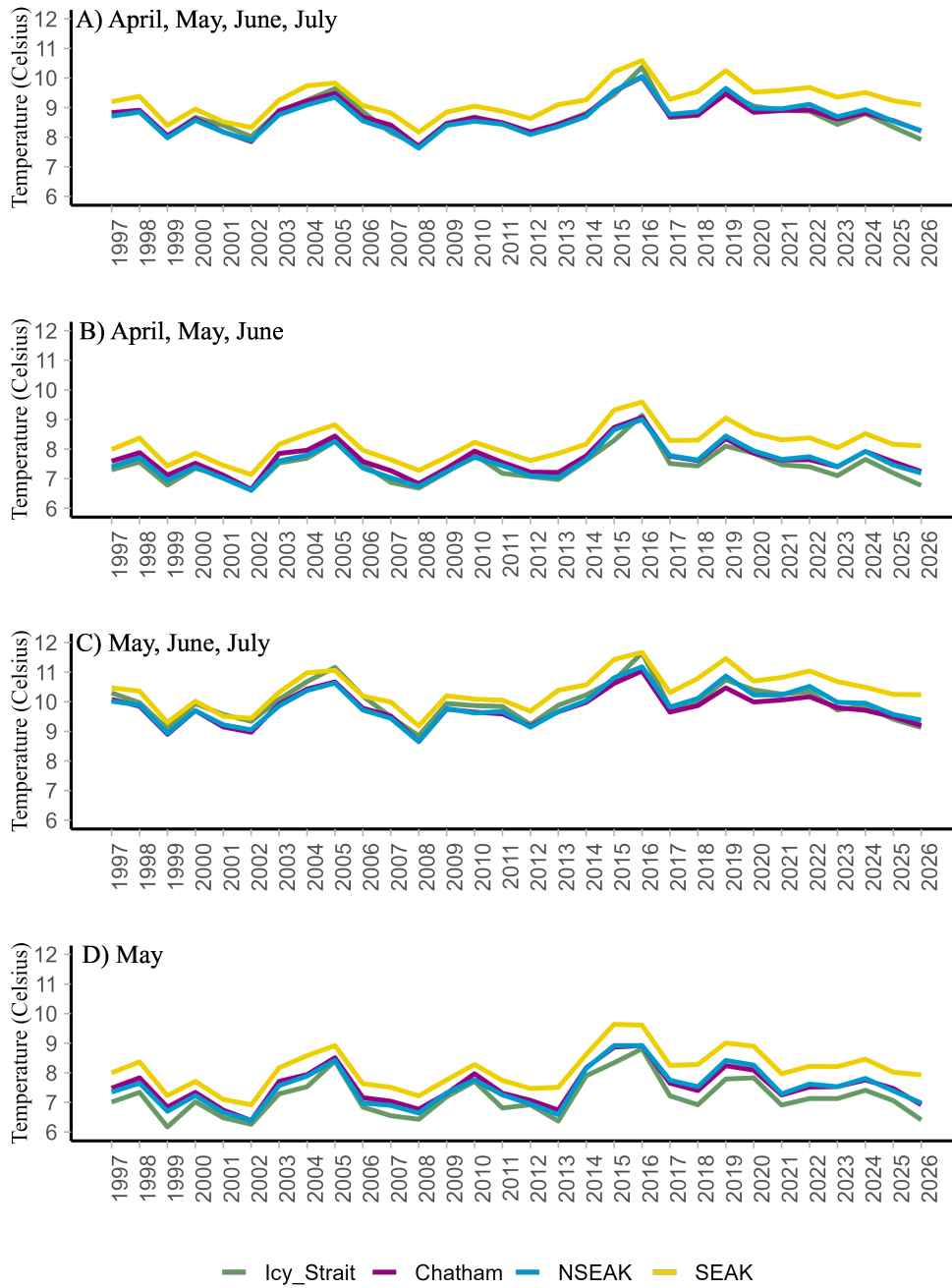


Figure 5: A. The May temperature averaged over each region (Chatham and Icy Straits, Icy Strait, NSEAK, SEAK) from 1997 through 2026. B. The May, June, and July temperature averaged over each region (Chatham and Icy Straits, Icy Strait, NSEAK, SEAK) from 1997 through 2026. C. The April through June temperature averaged over each region (Chatham and Icy Straits, Icy Strait, NSEAK, SEAK) from 1997 through 2026. D. The April through July temperature averaged over each region (Chatham and Icy Straits, Icy Strait, NSEAK, SEAK) from 1997 through 2026.

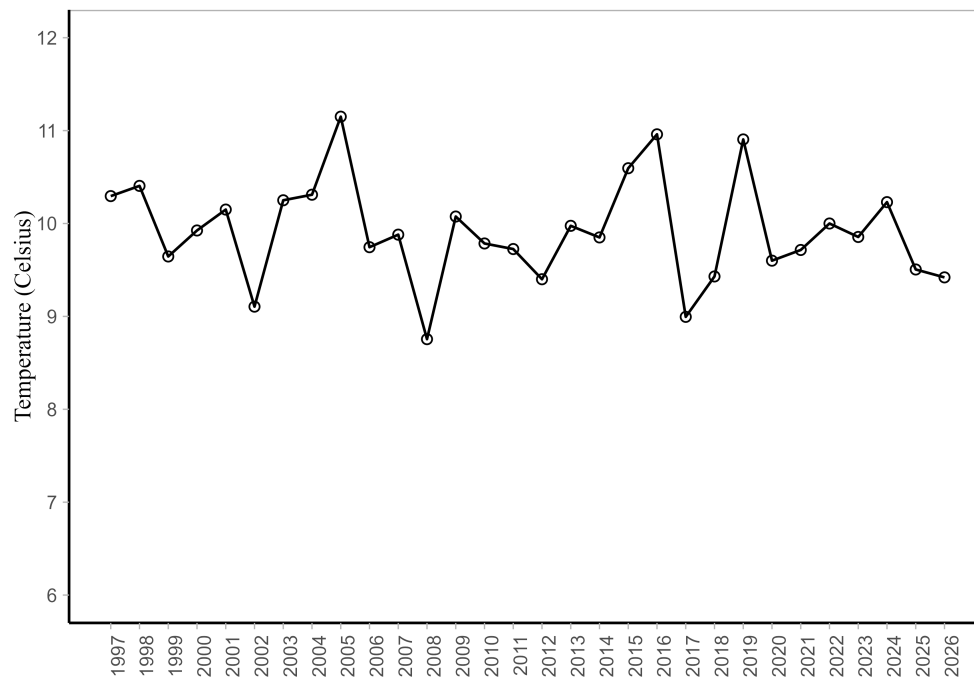


Figure 6: Average temperature (degrees Celsius) at 20m depth during June and July at 8 stations in Icy Strait (Icy Strait and Upper Chatham transects; ISTI) from 1997 through 2026.